Data dictionary Preuss & Wielhouwer (2024)

Scandals tab includes:

Congress	Congress in which scandal took place
Name	Full name of politician
Political position	House of Representatives or Senate
Break date	Date a scandal first appeared in any English language news article available on NexisUni
Major news date	Date a scandal first appeared in a English language major newspaper available on NexisUni, definition of major newspaper per NexisUni
Weekday	Weekday
Allegation	Case summary, based on newspaper articles
Pre-event visibility	Number of times a scandal politician's name appeared in the news in the five days preceding the event
Post-event visibility	Number of times a scandal politician's name appeared in the news in the five days following the event
Headline	Scandal sub-category
Category	Scandal upper-group category
Political leaning	Indicates whether scandal relates to a known political leaning of a scandal politician. Applies to discriminatory remarks
Consequences	Known consequences of scandal
Resigned or convicted	Indicates whether the politician resigned or was convicted within ten days of the break date
Reelection attempt	Indicates whether scandal politician attempted reelection
Reelected	Indicates whether scandal politician was reelected. Missing for politicians who did not run for reelection

Scandal references tab includes:

Break date	Date a scandal first appeared in any English language news article available on NexisUni
Major news date	Date a scandal first appeared in a English language major newspaper available on NexisUni, definition of major newspaper per NexisUni
Name	Full name of politician
Search term	Keyword used to identify the scandal break date
Break date source	News outlet in which break date article appeared
Break date title	Title of break date news article
Major news source	Major newspaper outlet in which first major newspaper article appeared
Major news title	Title of major news article

Deaths tab includes:

Congress	Congress in which politician passed away
Name	Full name of politician
Political position	House of Representatives or Senate
Date	Date of death
Break date	Date news about a death first appeared in any English language news article available on NexisUni
Major news date	Date news about a death first appeared in a English language major newspaper available on NexisUni, definition of major newspaper per NexisUni

Weekday	Weekday
Sudden	Indicates whether death was unexpected
Cause of death	Cause of death as identified in news articles
Case summary	Case summary, based on newspaper articles
Retired	Indicates whether politician retired prior to passing away
Pre-event visibility	Number of times a deceased politician's name appeared in the news in the five days preceding the event
Post-event visibility	Number of times a deceased politician's name appeared in the news in the five days following the event
First disease revelation	Date of the first revelation of health concerns that appeared in the same congressional cycle in which the politician passed away
Weekday first disease revelation	Weekday of the first revelation of health concerns that appeared in the same congressional cycle in which the politician passed away
Search term	Keyword used to identify the date an illness (or death) was first mentioned the first time since the most recent election.
Break date source	Source in which article about the first disease revelation appeared
Break date title	Title of the article in which the first disease revelation appeared

Politician details tab includes:

Name	Full name of politician
Assumed congressional office	Date a politician first assumed a congressional office
Left congressional office	Date a politician left a congressional office
FEC ID Senate	Federal Election Commission identifier for Senate campaigns
FEC ID House	Federal Election Commission identifier for House of Representatives campaigns
FEC ID presidential	Federal Election Commission identifier for presidential campaigns
Charles Stewart ID	Charles Stewart congressional committees identifier

House cycles tab includes: House of Representatives election dates used to identify connected firms. A firm is connected if it contributed to the event politician's candidate committee in the election cycle preceding the scandal, or in the election cycle in which the event took place. In a regular cycle, Representatives are (re)elected every two years.

Senate cycles tab includes: Senate election dates used to identify connected firms. A firm is connected if it contributed to the event politician's candidate committee in the election cycle preceding the scandal, or in the election cycle in which the event took place. In a regular cycle, Senators are elected every six years. Every two years, a third of the Senate is (re)elected.

PAC reporting tab includes: Quarterly reporting dates, closing book dates, and filing deadlines used to identify contributions filed with the Federal Election Commission.